

Mozilla pays half a million dollars to support open source projects

Mozilla has announced that it has paid a total of US\$ 539,000 for supporting open source projects. The company runs the Mozilla Open Source Support (MOSS) programme to support open source developments around the globe.

"At Mozilla, we were born out of, and remain a part of, the open source and free software movement. Through the Mozilla Open Source Support (MOSS) programme, we recognise, celebrate and support open source projects that contribute to our work and to the health of the Internet," said Gervase Markham, policy engineer, Mozilla Corporation, in a blog post.

Amongst other major open source projects, Mozilla awarded the biggest



amount of US\$ 194,000 to Ushahidi, which is an open source software platform for crowdsourcing,

monitoring, visualising and responding to reports from people suffering during times of political turmoil and subject to governmental or vigilante abuse. The Mountain View, California based company has also supported projects like WebAssembly backer Backpack, email security platform RiseUp, HTML5 game engine Phaser and Apache module Mod_md.

In August this year, Mozilla launched its 'Global Mission Partners: India' initiative, which allocated Rs 10 million for Indian open source projects that promoted Mozilla's mission. The company also ran several audits on codebases of open source developments such as expat (an XML parser) and GNU libmicrohttpd (an embedded HTTP server) through the Secure Open Source arm of MOSS.

Companies like Accenture, Infosys and Intel have partnered with Oracle to start deploying the newly launched Oracle Blockchain Cloud Service. "Our collaboration with Oracle is aimed at developing a blockchain cloud service for enterprises that helps to advance the privacy of blockchain transactions and improves the interoperability of traditional databases and blockchains," said Raejeanne Skillern, vice president of the data centre group and GM, cloud service provider group, Intel.

F# functional programming debuts on ASP.Net Core through Giraffe

Micro Web framework Giraffe has brought F# functional-style programming to ASP.Net Core. The latest development also includes interesting features like higher-order functions that have been much awaited on ASP.Net Core for years.

Giraffe offers a different technical philosophy that uses F# features like F# types, higher order functions and partial application of arguments. ASP.Net developers will benefit a lot by using the framework as it enables the development of Web API routes in a functional style. F# is already supported in ASP.Net Core MVC.

Developers need to plug Giraffe into the ASP.Net Core pipeline using middleware. Microsoft has published a detailed guide to help you use Giraffe to build a Web service with F# and the .NET Core 2.0 development platform. You might encounter some bugs since the framework is currently available in a beta stage. Having said that, the Giraffe team is working to improve the routing model for the framework.

Giraffe is known for its capabilities to build rich Web applications that are based on advanced F# features. Notably, the core of Giraffe is built on top of ASP.Net.

Microsoft maintains F# as the open source functional-first language. The language is designed to address complex computing problems using simple code.

Digitalisation and technological innovation lead to changing role of CIOs: Gartner

With the swift growth in the technology world, the nature of a chief information officer's (CIO) job has changed. A survey by Gartner has revealed that the CIO role is transitioning from being a delivery executive to a business executive, moving from controlling cost and engineering processes to driving revenue and exploiting data.

The survey, dubbed the 2018 Gartner CIO Agenda Survey, conducted with a record number of 3,160 CIO respondents across all major industries in 98



countries, highlights that 95 per cent of CIOs expect their jobs to change due to digitalisation. Respondents consider that world class IT delivery management and digitalisation are the two biggest transformations in the CIO role, followed by assuming increased and broader responsibilities and capabilities. "The CIO's role must grow and develop as digital business spreads, and disruptive technologies, including intelligent machines and advanced analytics, reach the masses," said Andy Rowsell-Jones, vice president and distinguished analyst at Gartner.